



here, because the defending side can pretty much be spawn camped, which is not fun.

“Specialists” lol

Battlefield 2042 features 10 playable “Specialists”, which at first glance seem to be based on the four original Battlefield classes, i.e., Assault, Support, Recon and Engineer. Turns out, the classes mean nothing. You don’t need to pick a medic to be a healer, you just need to equip the medical crate gadget. You don’t need to be an engineer to repair stuff, anyone can equip a repair tool. Plus all specialists can equip any gun. The only thing that makes them stand apart is a single ability unique to each of them, like for instance, Rao can jam

vehicles, Casper has an OV-P Recon drone for scouting, etc. This still isn’t enough to make it feel like picking any specific specialist will make much of a difference to a team.

Hazard Zone

Why did we bring up Specialists before talking about Hazard Zone? Because this is pretty much the only game mode where they actually matter. Hazard Zone is a battle royal-esque game mode, where up to

32 players, or 8 teams of 4 drop in to collect data drives scattered across the map.

At the start of a Hazard Zone match, you can pick any available Specialist, you can’t have two of the same on a

team though. Your loadout is limited however, since you won’t have many credits to spend on your loadout. Your credits carry over to the next match, so dropping in, looting a few drives and extracting would mean that eventually you would have enough credits to get your favourite weapon with all the customisations you want. This, in turn, should allow you to stay longer and loot more drives. Successfully extracting also nets you Extraction Streaks, which unlocks extra Tactical Equipment slots for your specialist.

The sense of progression in Hazard Zone is great, plus it makes the Specialists and choosing the right team comp actually matter. However, Hazard Zone still isn’t the best mode Battlefield 2042 has to offer. That honour goes to...

Portal

Probably the most fun game mode in Battlefield 2042, Portal mode basically allows players to create their own game modes, with their rules and whatnot. The mode’s toolkit includes maps and weapons from Bad Company 2, Battlefield 3, and Battlefield 1942. In addition to player created content, there are a few preset modes, all of which feel so much better to play than All-Out Warfare. The real fun, though, lies in the amount of player customisation and rule-tweaking you can do. All the rules and values can be tweaked to include some ridiculous stipulations, like needing to jump a set number of times in order to reload.

Verdict

Battlefield 2042 tried too hard to become the biggest battlefield ever, and unfortunately, the game’s core game mode, All-Out Warfare, is the least fun of all of its offerings. The new Hazard Zone game mode is actually a pretty good but the Portal mode takes the cake and is the only thing that makes Battlefield 2042 even slightly worth picking up. Of course, there’s also the long list of bugs plaguing the game. And we never really came across any of those massive weather events, which is kind of a bummer. We’ve heard they’re fairly awesome. *

MOAR!

DEVELOPER

DICE

PUBLISHER

Electronic Arts

PLATFORMS

Xbox Series X and Series S, PlayStation 4, PlayStation 5, Xbox One, Microsoft Windows

PLAYED ON

Microsoft Windows (Origin)

PRICE

₹2,999 (Standard Edition)

In its current state, there’s very little of Battlefield 2042 that isn’t plagued with bugs. In fact, there are some bugs that have actually carried over from recent Battlefield titles! It’s a sad state of affairs when players still need to deal with the exact same issues despite the game spending much longer in development.

Breakthrough

Breakthrough mode attempts to bring all the action to one point, with an attacking and defending team. Once a zone is captured, it can’t be recaptured. This also means you’ve got all 128 players vying for a single zone, be it either defending or attacking. The attacking side seemingly has an advantage